THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 7 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 6: **The Rise of Empires** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. How does the building of roads and rest houses benefit rulers? 1

(a) it ends travel **(b)** it hides troops
(c) it blocks trade **(d)** it helps control territory and revenue

2. How does an inscription differ from a literary text as a source? 1

(a) it can change
(b) it is a story
(c) it is long
(d) it is fixed in time and place by the ruler

3. A moral decline in kings is said to cause the fall of dynasties. Which Mauryan fact supports a different explanation? 1

(a) no army **(b)** no edicts
(c) financial strain and weak successors **(d)** no capital

4. A possible reason for the empire's decline was 1

(a) too many rulers **(b)** no capital
(c) dependence on a strong central ruler **(d)** no revenue at all

5. Which statement best evaluates Ashoka's legacy? 1

(a) he was a trader
(b) he is remembered for compassion and the use of power for welfare
(c) he is remembered for conquests only
(d) he is forgotten

6. Which of these is evidence that the Mauryas cared for welfare? 1

(a) tax records
(b) wide armies
(c) wells, rest houses and hospitals mentioned in edicts
(d) war booty

7. Which source type is best for studying Ashoka's own policies? 1

(a) modern stories **(b)** coins
(c) foreign visitors' tales **(d)** his inscriptions

8. Which feature of the Mauryan state would be called 'bureaucratic'? 1

(a) a network of paid officials **(b)** local assemblies only
(c) no officials **(d)** a council of elders only

9. **Assertion (A):** Chandragupta Maurya was the last Nanda king. 1
Reason (R): The last Nanda king was Dhana Nanda.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** Megasthenes, a Greek ambassador, visited Chandragupta's court. 1
Reason (R): He wrote an account called the Indica.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why did the empire need spies? 2

12. Why is the Indica incomplete today? 2

13. How did dhamma differ from conquest? 2

14. What does the saptanga illustrate? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Examine the role of Kautilya in the establishment of the Mauryan Empire. 3

16. Evaluate the saptanga model as a theory of the state. 3

17. Examine the diplomatic contacts of the Mauryas. 3

OR

Compare Chandragupta's and Ashoka's methods of rule. 3

18. Examine the role of religion in Mauryan politics. 3

OR

Analyse the role of public works in building the state's legitimacy. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** After conquering Kalinga, Ashoka saw the death and suffering that war had caused. He gave up war and turned to dhamma. He had messages carved on rocks and pillars in Brahmi script and appointed dhamma mahamattas to look after the welfare of the people. 5
(i) Which war changed Ashoka?
(ii) Which script did he use in most edicts?
(iii) What was the role of the dhamma mahamattas?
(iv) Why did Ashoka have his messages inscribed on rocks and pillars?

20. Discuss how historians use inscriptions, texts and archaeology to reconstruct Mauryan history. 5

OR

Discuss the cultural diffusion due to the Mauryan Empire and Greek contact. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks